



UAST STUDENT HANDBOOK

University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh, Benue State...

Where minds are developed for society's gain

2026

NATIONAL ANTHEM

Nigeria we hail thee,
Our own dear native land,
Though tribe and tongue may differ,
In brotherhood, we stand,
Nigerians all, and proud to serve,
Our sovereign Motherland.

Our flag shall be a symbol
That truth and justice reign,
In peace or battle honour'd,
And this we count as gain,
To hand on to our children
A banner without stain.

O God of all creation,
Grant this our one request,
Help us to build a nation
Where no man is oppressed,
And so with peace and plenty
Nigeria may be blessed.

NATIONAL PLEDGE

I pledge to Nigeria my country
To be faithful, loyal and honest
To serve Nigeria with all my strength
To defend her unity and uphold her honour and glory
So help me God

UAST ANTHEM

PRINCIPAL OFFICERS OF THE UNIVERSITY

The following are principal officers of the University:

VICE CHANCELLOR

REGISTRAR

DEPUTY VICE CHANCELLOR FOR ACADEMIC AFFAIRS

DEPUTY VICE CHANCELLOR FOR ADMINISTRATION

BURSAR

UNIVERSITY LIBRARIAN

PREFACE

University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST), Ithigh offers a university education with Nigerian, American, European blend within the Core Curriculum and Minimum Academic Standard (CCMAS) set by the National Universities Commission (NUC). At UAST, the student is prepared to be a responsible citizen that is able to think creatively, respect the opinions and views of others, and work with teams on solving problems of society. Rules, regulations and policies in this Student Handbook are intended to regulate student life on campus, maintain order, and serve as a student guide in the University. It is the responsibility of every student to read through the Handbook University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithigh carefully and familiarize themselves with its provisions as ignorance is not an excuse.

Your admission to this University is a privilege and an expression of hope and confidence in your ability to fulfil all academic and other requirements for an academic degree of the University. I urge you to turn promise to performance. On behalf of the Governing Council, Senate, faculty and staff of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, I welcome you to the University.

Registrar/Secretary of Council

VICE CHANCELLOR'S MESSAGE

The motto of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST)—*'Imagine, Aspire, Innovate, Create'*—derives naturally from the expertise and efforts of every member of its academic community and dedication to service of its owner, the Benue State Government in Nigeria.

At UAST, we believe in the role and significance of entrepreneurship for personal development, and are aware how much this is important for the nation's success. Our prominent and acknowledged faculty are accessible to mentor and guide you through your studies. Here, you will be given the support to develop your ideas, knowledge, skills, and initiatives. Our aim is to help you understand and prepare for the challenges in the world of agriculture, science, technology, entrepreneurship, and public life, and how these challenges can become opportunities for you to become a problem-solver and benefactor of your community; to help you develop into the nation's next generation of leaders and entrepreneurs, and to assist you to become the driving forces for shaping tomorrow's Benue State, Nigeria, Africa, and the world toward positive transformative impact.

UAST supports a modern Nigerian-, European-, and American-inspired curriculum with emphasis on skills acquisition, industry-readiness and a must-learn focus on technology and its connectedness to various fields of human adventure. Small class sizes and a guaranteed uninterrupted academic calendar enable you to graduate on schedule. You also have access to options to complete part of your degree study at partner universities in Europe, the UK, EURASIA, Russia, as well as the USA.

UAST offers a serene campus with areas for recreational and sports activities. You will enjoy access to state-of-the-art information technology resources in addition to an exclusive access to exceptional agriculture, science, allied health, and ICT laboratories, among others. Modern cafés, restaurants serving Nigerian and international cuisine, comfortable en-suite hostels, on-campus well-grassed football field, track and field athletics facilities, tennis and basketball courts, as well as a health care centre, are all provided on campus, with expansion undertakings. UAST supports a Wi-Fi (wireless)-enabled campus, and your security is guaranteed 24-hours-seven days a week, by well-trained and equipped UAST Campus Police, Benue State Police and complementary security architecture.

A university should not just be a place that provides textbook-based education, same as a library is not simply a place where books are neatly arranged on shelves! We are committed to providing you a place where you will exchange ideas, views, and experiences with fellow students, your professors, and many international experts. At UAST, you will be part of a wider academic community that has its basis on the common values of honesty, integrity, responsibility, partnership, respect for diversity, professionalism, open-mindedness, community involvement and globalisation engagement.

My colleagues and I look forward to helping you create your own unique stories and many meaningful moments at UAST, which you will be proud of.

Once again, you are highly welcome to University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST), Ihugh, Benue State, Nigeria.

Vice Chancellor

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SECTION ONE

BASIC INFORMATION ABOUT THE UNIVERSITY

1.1 The University Profile

University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST), Ihugh, Benue State, Nigeria was established under the Benue State Law—Benue State University of Agriculture, Science and Technology Law 2024 and via the issuance of an Operating License in May 2025, by the Government of the Federal Republic of Nigeria through the National Universities Commission (NUC).

1.2 Ownership

UAST is owned by the Benue State Government.

1.3 Management

UAST is managed by a composite body in line with the management systems of institutions in the Nigerian University system. The major components of the management structure include:

- The University Governing Council
- The Senate
- University Management Committee
- Committee of Deans
- School/Departmental Boards

1.4 Location

The University is located in Ihugh, Vandeikya Local Government Area of Benue State, Nigeria, about 120 kilometers from the Obudu Mountain Resort (formerly Obudu Cattle Ranch) in Cross River State, and about 41 kilometers from Gboko, the Tiv Capital of Benue State. The University has three campuses at Ihugh, including its Take-off campus of about 34 hectares and its main campus along the Ihugh-Vandeikya highway

1.5 Administrative Departments/Units

The University's day-to-day management activities are organized through a number of Administrative and Academic Departments/Units among which include:

- i) Office of Vice Chancellor

- ii) Office of Deputy Vice Chancellor(s)/Vice-President(s)
- iii) Office of Registrar
- iv) Office of University Librarian
- v) Office of University Bursar
- vi) Directorates & Centres.
- vii) Deans
- viii) Heads of Departments.

1.6 Vision, Mission & Value Statements

1.6.1 Vision

The vision of UAST is to be a leading centre in Agriculture, Science, and Technology, fostering research, innovation, and leadership for a sustainable, resilient, and prosperous society.

1.6.2 Mission

The Mission of UAST is to drive development through high-impact research, quality education, and community engagement.

1.6.3 Values

Values portray who we are individually and as corporate entity, because they shape attitude and behaviours towards the ideal. To this end UAST shall be guided by the following values in its internal and external activities and relationships:

- Excellence
- Integrity
- Innovation
- Accountability
- Sustainability
- Service
- Research Culture
- Global Competitiveness

1.7. UAST Students' Code of Ethics

The University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST) is committed to nurturing graduates who are intellectually competent, ethically responsible, innovative, and committed to national and global development. Every student is expected to uphold the highest standards of

honesty, integrity, discipline, and respect in all dealings within and outside the University. Accordingly, every student shall:

- i. **Pursue academic excellence** by diligently attending lectures, practical sessions, tutorials, examinations, and other approved academic activities, while continually striving to acquire relevant knowledge, skills, and competencies.
- ii. **Demonstrate honesty and integrity** in all academic and non-academic activities by avoiding examination malpractice, plagiarism, falsification of records, impersonation, and every other form of dishonesty.
- iii. **Respect the rights, dignity, and diversity of others**, treating fellow students, members of staff, visitors, and members of the public with courtesy, civility, and fairness regardless of ethnicity, religion, gender, disability, or social background.
- iv. **Conduct themselves responsibly** in a manner that promotes peace, mutual respect, discipline, and harmonious coexistence within the University community.
- v. **Protect and preserve University property and facilities**, using laboratories, libraries, classrooms, hostels, farms, workshops, equipment, information technology resources, and other University assets responsibly and only for authorized purposes.
- vi. **Comply with all University regulations** and all applicable laws of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, and cooperate with University authorities in maintaining order, safety, and security on campus.
- vii. **Maintain confidentiality** by respecting the privacy of other members of the University community and refraining from the unauthorized disclosure or misuse of confidential or privileged information.
- viii. **Refrain from all forms of harassment, intimidation, discrimination, bullying, cultism, violence, cyberbullying, hate speech, or any conduct capable of endangering the welfare, dignity, or safety of others.**
- ix. **Refrain from all forms of sexual harassment, sexual exploitation, or sexual misconduct**, whether involving fellow students, members of staff, or any other person associated with the University.
- x. **Use digital technologies and social media responsibly**, ensuring that online conduct reflects honesty, civility, and respect for others, and avoiding the publication or circulation of false, defamatory, obscene, or malicious content capable of bringing the University or any individual into disrepute.
- xi. **Attend lectures, practical sessions, examinations, meetings, and other official University activities punctually**, and actively participate in all approved academic and co-curricular programmes.

xii. **Dress decently and appropriately**, in accordance with University dress regulations, recognizing that appearance should reflect respect for self, others, and the dignity of the University.

xiii. **Promote environmental responsibility** by maintaining cleanliness, protecting the University's natural environment, supporting sustainable practices, and refraining from vandalism, littering, and environmental pollution.

xiv. **Serve as worthy ambassadors of UAST**, upholding the good name, values, and reputation of the University through exemplary conduct both on and off campus.

xv. **Report unethical, criminal, or unsafe conduct** through appropriate University channels and cooperate truthfully with any lawful investigation or disciplinary process.

1.8 Diversity, Equity and Inclusion

The **University of Agriculture, Science and Technology (UAST)**, **Ihugh** is committed to fostering a diverse, inclusive, respectful, and welcoming academic community in which every student and member of staff is treated with dignity, fairness, and respect. The University promotes equal opportunity and does not discriminate on the basis of gender, disability, race, ethnicity, age, religion, nationality, marital status, socio-economic background, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law or University policy.

UAST recognizes that diversity of backgrounds, perspectives, talents, abilities, experiences, and learning approaches enriches teaching, learning, research, innovation, and community life. The University therefore seeks to create an environment in which all members of its community are able to participate fully and contribute meaningfully to the attainment of the University's mission.

To achieve these objectives, all Faculties, Departments, Directorates, and Units of the University shall endeavour to:

i. **Promote a culture of mutual respect, dignity, fairness, and inclusion** for all members of the University community.

ii. **Recognize, value, and accommodate diversity** in ways that enhance learning, innovation, collaboration, and personal development.

iii. **Plan, provide, and utilize human, physical, and technological resources** in a manner that promotes accessibility, equity, and inclusiveness for all students and staff.

- iv. **Provide appropriate academic, administrative, and student support services** that enable all students, including those with disabilities and other special needs, to participate effectively in University life.
- v. **Promote intercultural understanding, tolerance, and peaceful coexistence** among members of the University community through education, dialogue, and responsible conduct.
- vi. **Ensure that no student or member of staff is subjected to discrimination, harassment, victimization, or exclusion** on any prohibited ground, and encourage the prompt reporting and fair resolution of any such complaints in accordance with University policies.

1.9 Motto

The motto of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology is: ‘Imagine, Aspire, Innovate, Create’

1.10 The Disciplinary System

It is required that every student of the University maintain a high standard of personal integrity. Each student shall conduct himself/herself peaceably in espousing any changes which he/she may consider necessary. The University regards as serious offence any act of unethical, immoral, dishonest, disloyal or destructive behaviour, as well as the violation of University regulations. It is the responsibility of each student not only to acquaint him/herself with these regulations but to assist to uphold them at all times.

Although, the University is committed to the full support of the legitimate rights of its members, it has an equal obligation to protect its educational purpose and the interest of its entire community. For this reason, the University is naturally concerned about the actions of some individuals and groups of individuals which may be in conflict with the wellbeing and integrity of the University, or in disregard of rights of other members of the community.

The legitimate expression of differing opinion and concern is an essential part of the academic community; but the imposition of opinions and concerns upon those who, in turn, dissent from them shall not be tolerated.

It is emphasised that all members of the University community including students are subject to the laws of the nation whether within or outside the University premises, like all other citizens. They are expected to learn to handle problems intelligently, reasonably, and with understanding and consideration for the right of others. Each member shall recognize that as he/she prizes rights and freedom for him/herself so also is he/she expected to respect the rights and freedom of others.

The University reserves the right, upon evidence of a student's failure to abide by its Rules, Code of Conduct and Regulations, to discipline him/her or to require, through the established disciplinary process, his/her withdrawal from the University.

The laws governing the University vest the Vice-Chancellor with the power to discipline students. In practice, there is a Student Disciplinary Committee to assist with the general function of dealing with individual cases of indiscipline. The Vice-Chancellor can exercise this power through the Dean of Students, Heads of Departments, Hostel Patrons/Matrones and certain other officers of the University to secure disciplinary order among students.

1.11 Directive on Student Expression

The University recognizes the crucial importance of maintaining open communication and dialogue in the process of identifying and resolving problems which may arise from the dynamics of life in the University. All members of the University Community are therefore, free to examine and discuss all questions of interest to them and to express opinions. However, it is the legitimate right of any member of the Community to dissent, disagree, hold different opinion, or think differently from others.

The University endorses academic freedom; but for it to be effective, the Community must always be protected from attacks by extremists of whatever persuasion, who would negate this essential freedom of inquiry by their coercive and disruptive action which interfere with the rights and freedom of others. Equally, students are free to support causes by all orderly means as long as they do not disrupt the regular and essential operations and activities of the University since such disruption would violate the responsible exercise of free enquiry and expression.

SECTION TWO

GOVERNANCE OF THE UNIVERSITY

2.1 The Structure

UAST is governed by a composite body in line with the management systems of institutions in the Nigerian University system. The major components of the management structure are: the University Governing Council, Senate, University Management Committee, Committee of Deans/Directors, and School/ Departmental Boards.

The University's day-to-day administration is organized through a number of offices, notably, the Vice-Chancellor, who is the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), the Deputy Vice-Chancellor(s), the University Registrar, the University Librarian, the University Bursar, Directors of Institutes/Centres, the Deans of Schools, and Heads of Departments.

2.2 Visitor

The Executive Governor of Benue State is the Visitor of the University and exercises strategic oversight of the University.

2.3 Governing Council

The Governing Council is the supreme governing authority of the University, responsible for those decisions of policy which have financial implications, the general management of the affairs of the University, and the control of property and expenditure of the University. Some members of Council are drawn from the general public as prescribed in the University Law. The-Pro-Chancellor is the Chairman of Council. Its membership also includes the Vice-Chancellor and Deputy Vice-Chancellors, representatives of the University Senate, the Congregation, Convocation, and Registrar as Secretary. The University Librarian and Bursar may be in attendance. The work of the Council is carried out by its Standing Committees.

2.4 Senate

The Senate is the highest decision making body on academic matters in the University. It receives advice from Boards of Schools and its own Committees. Its membership consists of the Vice-Chancellor as Chairman, Deputy Vice-Chancellors, Deans, all Professors and Heads of

Departments, the University Librarian, representatives as prescribed in the University Law, and Registrar as Secretary.

On the whole, the Senate organises and controls admissions, teaching, discipline of students, as well as promotes research in the University.

2.5 Congregation

Congregation is the general assembly of all University staff, both teaching and non-teaching who are degree holders. The Vice-Chancellor is its Chairman. The Congregation has the general function of serving as a forum for discussing any University problem or issue and making recommendations to Council and Senate.

2.6 Vice-Chancellor

The Vice-Chancellor is the Chief Executive and Academic Head of the University. He is vested by law with the general function of directing the activities of the University, for which purpose he/she is advised and assisted by the Deputy Vice-Chancellors, Registrar, Bursar, University Librarian, Deans, Directors and Heads of Department.

2.7 Registrar

The Registrar is the Chief Administrative Officer of the University and is responsible to the Vice-Chancellor for the day-to-day administrative work of the University. The Registry is presently organized into three main sections namely, Academic Affairs Unit (Senate, Exams and Records, Admissions); Establishment Unit (Human Resources—Senior and Junior staff matters), and General Administration.

2.8 Bursar

The Bursar is the Chief Financial Officer of the University and is responsible to the Vice-Chancellor for the day-to-day administration and control of the financial affairs of the University.

2.9 University Librarian

The University Librarian is responsible to the Vice-Chancellor for the administration of the University Library and the co-ordination of all library services in the University.

2.10 School Boards

The Schools of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology are: Agriculture, Science and Technology, Allied Health Sciences, and Computing.

Every School is governed by an academic board which broadly controls the academic programmes of the School subject to the approval of the Senate. The Chairman of each School Board is the Dean, who is elected by the members of the School or appointed (only in interim capacity) by the Vice-Chancellor for a specific period of time from among the Full Professors in the particular School. Part of the functions of the Dean is to present at convocation for the conferment of degrees, persons who have qualified for degrees of the University at examinations held in the various Departments within the School.

SECTION THREE

UNIVERSITY LIBRARY

3.1 Stock:

The Library of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh has volumes of information resources, print and non-print in all the courses offered in the University and other areas of human and societal knowledge.

3.2 Opening Hours

The Library is opened for readers every day of the week during the periods specified below:

- | | | |
|------------------|---|------------------------|
| i) Monday-Friday | - | 8.00 a.m. – 9.00 p.m. |
| ii) Saturday | - | 12.00 noon – 6.00 p.m. |
| iii) Sunday | - | 2.00 p.m. – 6.00 p.m. |

During the University general examinations, the University Library shall extend opening hours which shall be published to the University community.

Furthermore, the Library is opened during holidays for shorter period, but closed on Public Holidays unless there is a special request.

3.3 Registration

All members of the University as may be defined in the Statutes are qualified to register to use the Library. These include all students, the academic, administrative and senior technical staff and such other persons as may be determined by the Library Committee or the University Librarian.

3.4 Admission to the Library

The use of the University Library is opened to a person who has signed an undertaking to observe the Library rules and regulations and issued with a Library Identity Card. The holder of the ID card must produce the card to any official of the Library on demand, who may prohibit entry to anyone unable to produce it. Registration must be renewed at the beginning of each academic year. Library tickets (or digital codes/ID) are meant for users to borrow books from the Library and it is not transferable. A valid Identity Card (ID) of the University is required for any user of the Library.

3.5 Library Discipline and Security

The disciplinary measures of the Library include:

- i) Silence must be observed in and around the Library;
- ii) Brief cases, bags, waterproofs, umbrellas, etc. may not be brought into the library; but if brought into the Library they must be left in the place provided at the owners' risk;
- iii) Mobile phones (GSM) are allowed in the Library; but they MUST be switched off or placed on silence;
- iv) No patron may enter any part of the Library marked 'Reserved for staff' unless by permission;
- v) There shall be no smoking in the library;
- vi) The use of any form of naked light, including candles, is strictly prohibited in the Library;
- vii) Food MUST not be taken into the library;
- viii) No book may be marked, defaced, or damaged in any way. Readers are held responsible for any damage to books in their charge;
- ix) All persons leaving the Library must show books or papers in their possession to the Library Security Official and subject themselves to be searched when requested; and,
- x) The computer systems, internet and e-resources at the Library are meant for teaching and learning purposes.

Note that other Library regulations are contained in the Library Policy document.

SECTION FOUR

POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

The following policies and procedures are intended to guide students throughout their days in the University.

4.1 Rules and Regulations

UAST is established primarily to educate students, inculcate cultural development and good character in them. A student's acceptance of the University admission automatically implies that he/she has accepted to abide by the Rules and Regulations that may from time to time be made by the University. Such acceptance also carries with it an obligation that the student shall conduct himself/herself as a law-abiding and responsible member of the academic community, in accordance with the University's Rules and Regulations.

Specifically, the regulations put in place to guide students include:

- i) **Admission Procedures:** Students must meet the accepted cut off mark of Unified Tertiary Matriculation Examination (UTME) + Post Unified Tertiary Matriculation Examination (PUTME) to qualify for admission into the University.
- ii) **Entry Requirements:** Five Credits in Ordinary Level including English and Mathematics in WASC, SSCE, NECO, or NABTEB, in not more than two sittings.
- iii) **Payment of School Charges:** All School charges must be paid before the end of each Academic Session as prescribed.
- iv) **Class Attendance:** Students are expected to attend classes regularly. Students must meet 75% attendance to qualify to write examination in any course registered for in the session.
- v) **Continuous Assessment:** Continuous Assessment consists of written or oral tests, term paper assignments, pop-up quizzes, seminar presentations, fieldwork reports, group projects, mid-semester examinations, etc., as may be determined by the course instructor. Continuous Assessment is compulsory and carries 40% (out of which 5% is for class attendance) for each course registered for in an academic session, unless varied by Senate and communicated to both staff and students at the beginning of each academic session.

4.2 Clearance and Registration Procedure for Fresh Students

Step 1: All fresh students must obtain their UAST admission letter from the Admissions Office of the University, or by email.

Step 2: At the **Clearance Centre** of the University, fresh students are to present the following documents:

- i) Letter of Admission to the University issued by both Joint Admissions and Matriculation Board (JAMB) and UAST;
- ii) Academic credentials (e.g. certificates or statements of result for relevant national or international school certificate examinations or diplomas, transcripts, etc.) and JAMB Result Slip (not notification of result);
- iii) Birth Certificate or Statutory Declaration of Age;
- iv) Citizenship or place of origin certification (e.g. Local Government/State Certificate or International Passport);
- v) Medical report from a recognised Government Hospital;
- vi) Evidence of payment of the Admission Acceptance Deposit Fee (AADF);
- vii) Eight (8) recent coloured passport-size photographs with their name and program of study clearly written on the reverse side of the photographs; and,
- viii) Three (3) photocopies of each of the items i)-v) above and submit at the Clearance Centre.

Step 3: After the fresh students are cleared, they are to make payment of appropriate fees at the designated banks, and obtain a bank teller.

Step 4: All students shall submit the bank teller to the University Finance Department and obtain in return an appropriate University fee receipt.

Step 5: All students shall present the original receipt at the Clearance Centre, and obtain the following forms:

- i) Student Advisement Form;
- ii) Certificate of Clearance Form; and,

Step 6: All students shall:

- i) Go to their respective Academic Department and present the completed Certificate of Clearance Form, which has been signed and stamped by an appropriate Clearance Officer, and a copy of the fees receipt. An assigned Advisor retains the receipt copy for payment evidence and assists them to complete the forms mentioned in Step 5;
- ii) Return to the Clearance Centre with four (4) copies of each of the completed forms: one (1) copy of each is retained by the student and one (1) copy of each is submitted to the student's School or Department. The originals are submitted at the Clearance Centre for Registry.
- iii) Take the third copy of each of the completed forms, as well as a copy of the University fee receipt, to the Hostel Hall Officer for assignment of a residential room;
- iv) Present the fourth copy of each of the completed forms, as well as a copy of the University fee receipt at the University Clinic, and go through the required medical examinations. After receiving a Medical Clearance Certificate, which is endorsed by the University Medical Director, students shall submit a copy of the Medical Certificate at the Clearance Centre to be issued with a PIN for online course registration and a Student Matriculation Number (SMN);
- v) Enrol in person in all courses for which they are eligible, as provided in this Handbook. It is the responsibility of students to familiarize themselves with the published schedule for lectures/tutorials/laboratory sessions for all courses they have registered for in the semester; and
- vi) Complete online registration of ONLY courses listed on the completed Advisement Form, and print out the form.

Step 7: All students shall submit a copy each of the online course registration print-out and Medical Certificate to: their Department office; School office; and University Registry (all through the Clearance Centre). This step COMPLETES the registration process.

NOTE: The above procedure is subject to modification for exigent reasons. Only students who complete all the seven steps mentioned, culminating in the issuance of Student Matriculation Numbers are deemed to be bona fide students of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithugh, and would be allowed to take lectures and write examinations. It is important to emphasise that the clearance and registration exercises last for only one (1) week.

4.3 Temporary Withdrawal

A duly registered student may for good cause (e.g. ill health or financial difficulty) apply for temporary withdrawal from the University by completing and submitting to his/her Head of Department a *Temporary Withdrawal Form*. Permission for temporary withdrawal shall be granted only by the University Senate. Temporary withdrawal with Senate's approval shall normally not be for more than one academic session.

4.4 Re-Admission after Withdrawal

A student who wishes to be re-admitted after a period of temporary withdrawal, shall apply at most two months before the beginning of the next academic session by completing and submitting the *Re-admission Form*.

4.5 Registration for Returning Students

All returning students of the University are required to register for courses for which they meet the prerequisite requirements in their programme of study on a semester-by-semester basis in every academic session. A returning student:

- Step 1:** Makes the appropriate fee payment and presents teller to the University's Finance Department for issuance of relevant receipt (s);
- Step 2:** Presents the receipt (s) to their respective School Office and collects a Student Advisement Form. (The receipt is also presented at the University Clinic for appropriate medical examinations, and at the appropriate student hostel for room assignment);
- Step 3:** Completes the Advisement Form with the assistance of the Programme/Department Advisor; and
- Step 4:** Completes online registration for ONLY courses listed on the Student Advisement Form, prints out, and submits a copy each of the print-out at their Department Office, School Office, and the Registry.

NOTE: Students are expected to complete their registration within one (1) week from the date of commencement of each semester.

4.6 Late Registration

Students who arrive late on campus, or who are unable to register during the regular registration period may participate in late registration after payment of the required fee. After the registration period, students who wish to take additional courses must wait until the following semester to

enrol in those courses. A late registration fee may apply for students who miss the regular registration period and seek to enrol during the first week of classes.

4.7 Admission to Classes

Students will not be admitted to classes unless they have registered, and either their name appears on the official class roster (which is made available to the course instructor by the office of the Registrar) or they present an authorized *permission-to-enrol form* from the office of the Registrar.

4.8 Withdrawal from Courses

Students may withdraw from one or more courses without penalty until the end of the fifth week of classes each semester. There will be no refund of tuition and other relevant fees for courses from which a student has withdrawn.

If the student withdraws within the first five weeks, the grade that is assigned is “Withdrawn” or “W.” This grade is not factored into the calculation of the Grade Point Average (GPA) or the Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) or the credit hours earned. After the fifth week of the semester, a student who drops a course will receive a grade of “Withdrawn Failing” (WF). The grade of “WF” is counted as an F and is calculated accordingly in the computation of the student’s GPA, CGPA, and credit hours attempted.

4.9 Student Status

At University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh, a full-time student is one who is admitted into a degree programme at the University, and who registers for 15 or more credit hours each semester (provided that no student shall register for more than 24 credit hours in any semester without Senate approval). A student may drop one or more courses (with appropriate permission) and still be considered a full time student provided she or he maintains enrolment of at least 15 credit hours. Any student who is enrolled in fewer than 15 credit hours (without appropriate authorization) is considered a part-time student. UAST does not operate a Part-time degree programme at this stage.

4.10 Grades

The grading system is based on letter grades. The student may receive A, B, C, D, E, or F. The grades equate to the following performance levels:

A	Truly outstanding work that demonstrates an excellent command of the subject.
B	Work that represents a very good command of the subject and that is well beyond average expectation for the course.

C	Work that represents a good command of the subject and clearly meets most of the expectations.
D or E	Work that is considered at a minimal passing level but demonstrates significant gaps in knowledge and falls short of expectations.
F	Work that demonstrates substantial shortcomings in knowledge and is insufficient in quality to warrant awarding credit for the course.

4.11 Computation of GPA and CGPA

The student's Grade Point Average (GPA) is computed on a five point scale each semester based on the student's grades that semester, using the following grade weights (values):

A	5.0
B	4.0
C	3.0
D	2.0
F	0.0

The GPA is calculated by multiplying the weighted value of the grade in the course by the number of credit hours that the course carries, producing the points earned for each course. Then the points earned for each course taken in the semester are added together, and the sum is divided by the sum of the credit hours for all of the courses taken in that semester. In this way, courses with more credit hours are weighted more heavily than courses with fewer credit hours. The formula is as follows:

Course Grade Weight X Credit Hours for the Course = Points Earned for Course

Sum of the Points Earned / Sum of Credit Hours = GPA

4.12 Registration at other Units

All students of the University are required to formally register and keep updated records with the following units of the University every academic session, and to observe their published rules and regulations:

- i) University Clinic;
- ii) University Library; and
- iii) Student Affairs Office.

4.13 Certificate Verification

University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ibadan reserves the right to verify and authenticate every document submitted by its students. If at any stage of a student's enrolment in the University, it is found that any certificates or credentials they presented at the time of admission are not genuine, the student shall be expelled from the University. Furthermore, the University shall withdraw any degrees, certificates, or diplomas already awarded if the awarded graduate is found to have presented fake academic credentials at the time of admission.

4.13.1 Certificate Screening

The screening of students' certificates is conducted at 200 level or second year of a student in the University. The steps for the screening of certificates are listed below:

- i) When submitting documents for screening, the student is advised to ensure that the photocopies of the documents he/she submits are legible, with all parts of the document appearing. The Certificate Screening Committee may call on the student to resubmit documents that are not clear.
- ii) The Certificate Screening Committee screens the results in certificates **not** statements of results. So, no type of statement of results is acceptable, whether the statement of results is web generated, handwritten, or typed. Alternatively, the Committee accepts centre printouts; this must be duly signed and rubberstamped by the Principal of the School the student graduated from.
- iii) Students who came in through Direct Entry must also submit certificate and not statements of result. In lieu of certificates, the Committee accepts duly signed and rubber stamped transcripts.
- iv) Consistency of the names of students is important. For example, **OJO JAMES** should not suddenly become **JAMES OJO** or **JIM OJO**. Should a student take a new name after the issuance of his/her certificates, he/she should provide official evidence of statutory change of name.
- v) Please learn to write your surname or family name last and in capitals and/or underlined: **Michael OKORO** and not **Okoro Michael**. Should the student be asked to write the surname or first name then he/she can write the surname first. Students are advised to choose one order of name and stick to it; **Michael OKORO**.
- vi) In all your correspondence, please insert your matriculation number after your name. Do not confuse your Matriculation number with registration number or any other number.

4.14 Change of Name

A student of the University who wishes to change his/her surname shall make a written application to the University Vice-Chancellor/President through his/her Dean and Head of Department, attaching legal evidence, including newspaper publication, in support of the stated reason(s) of the requested change (e.g. marriage in the case of a female student, or new evidence of different parentage). The University Senate shall consider and ratify such request. However, no first or middle name entered into the University records at the time of admission shall be changed.

4.15 Deferment

Upon payment of tuition fees, a fresh student, who wishes, may apply to the University Senate through the University Registrar for deferment of the admission. Upon approval, deferment shall be valid for only one academic session.

4.16 Academic Ceremonies

4.16.1 Matriculation

Only duly registered fresh students shall participate in the Matriculation ceremony of the University. And, it is only upon matriculation that the student is formally admitted into the University.

4.16.2 Convocation

The Convocation ceremony of the University shall hold, at which degrees, diplomas, certificates, awards and honours shall be awarded to deserving recipients as approved by the University Senate.

4.17 Change of Programme of Study

A student who desires to change his/her programme of study in the University may be permitted to do so upon the following conditions:

- i) A vacancy exists in the programme of study to which he/she seeks a change;
- ii) He/she satisfies all entry requirements for admission into the desired programme of study at the time the change is sought;
- iii) Such change of programme of study shall be subject to approval by the University Senate; and
- iv) The student must have obtained a Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of at least 2.50.

4.18 Student Class Attendance

Attendance of required lectures, tutorials, studio, laboratory, and workshop sessions, field trips, etc., is compulsory. Every student is required to meet a minimum of 75% class attendance in order

to qualify to write the Final Examination in a given course. Student attendance at each officially scheduled learning session shall be taken and signed by the instructor.

4.19 Award and Withdrawal of Degrees (Diplomas)

The University awards degrees (diplomas) to persons who are found by its Senate to be worthy in character and learning. Accordingly, the University shall withdraw a degree (diploma) from a former student if he/she is found wanting in character after graduation.

SECTION FIVE

MATRICULATION, MATRICULATION NUMBER AND IDENTITY CARD

5.1 Matriculations

Candidates who have satisfied the minimum educational requirements of the University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh are admitted as students. These are the only candidates who are eventually matriculated as students of the University. On matriculation day, each fresh student signs a declaration of his/her formal admission to the University and affirms that he/she will observe the Statutes and Rules of the University. All matriculating students are required to be formally dressed for the occasion. According to Senate Regulations, no student, unless he/she is matriculated, is allowed to remain in the University after the matriculation ceremony.

5.2 Matriculation Number

Sequel to completing registration, each student is matriculated with an assigned Matriculation Number. All official documents of the student are deemed complete or legitimate when they carry

the correct matriculation number, otherwise such student or document is illegitimate. Therefore, students are strongly advised to know their matriculation numbers and to use them on all official transactions.

5.3 Identity Card

Having registered in the University, the student is issued with a Student ID card valid for one session only and renewed at the onset of another academic session. Students may be required, at any time, to identify themselves upon request by authorized University officials in the performance of their duties. Certain University facilities are open only to students who are able to show valid identity cards upon request. It is instructive that students preserve their identity cards, carry them always and be ready to produce them at any time on demand. Any student withdrawing from the University must submit his/her identity card to the Registrar's Office and failure to do so shall be regarded as a misappropriation of a University property.

5.4 The Issuance of Identity Card

Any legitimate student of the University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh is issued an Identity Card by the Registrar's office. Further, he/she is required to carry the identity card at all times because students may be called upon to produce the cards at any time. No student may be admitted to the Library, lecture and examinations without the card. The Identity Card is a security document and all students are advised to secure it properly. Students are advised to report loss or theft of their Identity Cards to the Security Department and Dean of Students Affairs without delay.

5.5 The Student Affairs Unit

The Student Affairs Unit is responsible for the quality of the informal learning environment that students experience in the University community. Its primary concern is the student. Its functions are administrative, educational and social. Others include facilitating students' major needs such as accommodation, feeding arrangements and transport; provision of essential services like financial assistance through information on bursaries, scholarships and loans; promotion of healthy environment on campus by caring for the psychological and developmental needs through sporting activities and professional counselling and advising; and provision of productive, recreational, cultural and social activities.

In conjunction with the students, Faculties and other Administrative Units of the University, the Student Affairs Unit helps to provide the atmosphere and human relationship that are essential for

the students' overall adjustment, as well as equal opportunity to help them realize their potential as enlightened individuals and responsible members of society.

SECTION SIX

ACADEMIC REGULATIONS AND STANDARDS

6.1 Academic Counselling

Students will be assigned Programme Advisors within their Departments, who shall assist them with academic matters and provide needed explanations of University requirements and regulations.

6.2 Course Credit Unit

A course credit unit is one hour of lecture (or student-instructor contact) per week per semester.

6.3 Student Academic Workload

All full-time students shall take a minimum of 15 credit units per semester and a maximum of 48 credit units per session (as prescribed in the NUC CCMAS), except where a credit load restriction is imposed as provided in this Handbook. A student may apply to take more than the upper limit through the School Board for Senate's consideration.

6.4 Duration of a Semester

During each semester, eighteen (18) weeks shall normally be reserved for instruction, learning, and examinations, excluding public holidays. Of the sixteen (18) weeks, fifteen (15) weeks shall be for instruction and learning, one (1) week shall be for student revision, and two (2) weeks shall be reserved for Final Examinations.

6.5 Continuous Assessment

Assessment of students' academic work shall be continuous, and this shall make up 40% of the total assessment score (of which 5% is for attendance) for the course. Every student shall partake in Continuous Assessment, which should be a combination of pop-up quizzes, periodic tests, home-work assignments, mid-semester examination, etc. Accordingly, students could be asked to present term papers, work on projects, write essays, present seminar talks, participate in Oral Examinations, etc.

6.6 Final Examination

There shall be a final examination at the end of the semester for every course (except in peculiar courses which do not require this). The final examination shall form 60% of the course grade weighting.

6.7 Grading System

Students' academic work at the end of every semester shall be scored according to the following letter grades, percentile scores, and Letter Grade Points:

Letter Grade	Percentile Scores (%)	Letter Grade Points Assigned
A	70 – 100	5.00
B	60 – 69	4.00
C	50 – 59	3.00
D	45 – 49	2.00
E	40-44	1.00

6.8 Appeal for Re-Assessment

A student may request for a re-assessment of the quality of his/her work within one week after publication of results. When a student makes the request in the approved format (i.e. completing the *Re-assessment Request Form*), he/she shall pay a re-assessment charge of Ten Thousand Naira (₦10, 000.00) only, which is subject to Senate's review from time to time. The process for re-assessment shall begin only after presentation to the applicant's Department evidence of payment to the Bursary Department. The charge is refundable only if the appeal is successful (i.e. it results in a higher grade for the course), and the re-assessment shall be done by an instructor other than the course instructor). The re-assessed grade shall be the final when approved by Senate.

6.9 Incomplete Grade

If for some verifiable reasons such as ill health, financial difficulties, and unavoidable exigencies, a student is unable to complete or fulfil the required semester academic work and assessments, a letter grade of "I" or a remark of "Incomplete" shall be entered for him/her by the course instructor,

and the student has at most four full semesters to remedy this by completing the required work and assessments for the course. Until this is done, the course shall not be considered for computation of GPA or CGPA for the student.

However, at the end of the next four semesters, on failure to remedy the grade, a grade letter of “F” shall be substituted or any other grade that the student’s completed work (at the time he/she was officially allowed to leave the University) deserves, which shall only be reversed if evidence is presented that the original reason(s) for incomplete academic work still subsist(s).

6.10 Absence from an Examination

A student, who absents himself/herself from the final examination of a semester without written permission from the Vice-Chancellor through the Head of Department and Dean of the School during or at the end of the semester, will be deemed to have failed the final examination. A student who has not met 75% attendance and has been disqualified to take the Final Examination will be deemed to have failed the Examination.

If a student is absent from the final examination on permission, he/she will be allowed to write the examination as first attempt at the next available opportunity. The units of the course(s) shall not be used to compute the student’s GPA in the semester of deferment.

6.11 Repeated Course Grade

When a student re-registers for a course failed at earlier attempt (s), and takes the examination in the course, he/she shall be credited with the actual grade scored in the repeated examination. The new pass grade earned in a repeated course shall not replace the ‘F’ grade in the student's record. The new pass grade appears in the student’s transcripts, and shall be used for the calculation of CGPA in the semester it is earned.

6.12 Academic Warning, Probation, Restriction, Suspension and Withdrawal

Students are expected to maintain a level of academic performance sufficient to ensure that they meet all academic requirements to receive the degree that they are pursuing. Minimally, students are expected to achieve a GPA of 1.00 each semester and maintain a CGPA of 1.00, which is the minimum required for graduation. Students who fail to do so are subject to the following:

6.12.1 Academic Warning

A student shall be given an Academic Warning in any semester when his/her GPA falls below 1.00 even if the CGPA is excellent. This will be indicated on his/her result slip for the semester. No further action is required.

6.12.2 Academic Probation

A student shall be placed on Academic Probation if his/her CGPA falls below 1.00 after two

consecutive semesters. The student shall be informed in writing (either on his/her result slip or otherwise) by the Registrar of the University after the release of the relevant semester results. A student on probation shall be counselled to change to a cognate Programme for which he/she meets the admission requirements and take not more than 15 credit hours of work per semester until his/her GPA rises to 1.00 and above.

6.12.3 Academic Withdrawal

At any point a student demonstrates continued inability to meet minimum academic requirements after the transfer to another Programme, based on academic performance and upon review by the Senate, he/she will be informed in writing to withdraw from the University.

6.13 Inter/Intra-School Transfer

Students currently registered in any degree programme of the University for at least one academic session, and who have a minimum CGPA of 2.50 may apply for transfer to another Programme, Department, or School.

A student seeking to transfer from one School to another shall have a minimum CGPA of 2.50. A student seeking to transfer shall complete the University Transfer Form and submit same to the Head of the Department from which the student is seeking transfer. All applications for transfer are subject to recommendation of the Board of the School to which the student is seeking transfer. Approval of such transfers shall be obtained from Senate.

6.14 Transfers from other Institutions

Students currently admitted and registered in any full-time Programme in other recognized and accredited Universities, and who wish to transfer their studies to University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh would be considered at the beginning of a new academic session, subject to the following criteria:

i) Level of Entry

The ceiling of entry shall be 200 or 300 level for any degree programme of four or five year's duration, respectively. The student would be required to satisfy any deficiencies which would be determined from the transcript.

ii) Transfer of Credits from other Institutions

Students transferring from other recognized Universities may be credited with units for courses successfully completed, and which satisfy the course requirements of the programme for which the student wishes to be registered at the University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ihugh. The units and grade points awarded shall be placed in the appropriate equivalent courses and level in the degree programme. A transfer student to 200 or 300 level,

shall not normally be credited with more than 48 or 72 units for courses taken in other Universities.

iii) **Minimum CGPA**

A transfer student from another University must have a minimum CGPA of 2.50 on a five-point system.

iv) **Processing Fee**

A non-refundable fee of one hundred thousand naira (N100, 000) only shall be charged as processing fee from the student. (The fee is subject to review by University Senate).

v) **Expelled Students**

On no account shall a student who had been expelled as a result of cultism or any misconduct be admitted on transfer to the University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithigh.

vi) **Inter-University Transfer Form**

The transfer student must complete the Inter-University Form of University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithigh, and provide all required documents as stated on the form.

vii) **Senate Approval**

University Senate considers the transfer application (guided by the Registrar's recommendation) at least two (2) months before the commencement of a new academic session. Senate's decision to approve or otherwise is final.

6.15 Student Evaluation of Instructors and Courses

Students shall evaluate themselves, instructors and courses they have registered for and taken each semester during the last two weeks of lectures before commencement of the final examinations, using the approved University Student-Instructor-Course Evaluation Form as follows:

- i) An Academic Departmental staff from the instructor's Department (or a faculty member other than the course instructor) takes the forms in a sealed envelope bearing the name of the instructor, course code, and level or class section that the instructor teaches, to the classroom at a time the instructor holds the class.
- ii) Students are allowed at most 15 minutes to complete the forms and return to the staff, who puts all of them back in the envelope and leaves the classroom.
- iii) The completed forms are all sealed in the same envelope and sent to the Directorate of Academic Planning & Quality Assurance (DAP & QA) for processing.

- iv) The report on each instructor is sent to their Head of Department through the Dean's office for follow-up and appraisal purposes.

6.16 Student Exchange Programme

- (1) *Two-Semester Exchange Programme:* The University encourages student exchange programme with selected accredited Universities abroad to enable its students to study at those Universities for a maximum of two semesters and transfer all earned credits and points to University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ibadan; this is to promote academic and international exposure of its students. This programme is available only to students who have completed and fulfilled 200 Level (Year 2: Sophomore) course requirements within their programmes of study, and whose CGPA is at **least 3.50**. Eligible students shall complete appropriate Student Exchange Forms at the office of the Dean of Student Affairs, and submit same to the Registrar's office (through their respective Departments and Schools) for processing by the end of their fourth semester in the University. The selection of beneficiaries shall be announced by the office of the Vice-Chancellor.
- (2) *2+2 (or 3+2) Undergraduate Programme:* The University, in alignment with NUC-approved Transnational Education (TNE) models, and in coordination with its foreign partner universities, enables interested students to spend the first two years (or three years, for 5-year degree programmes) at UAST, and the subsequent two years at one of its partner universities abroad. This dual degree programme aims at providing a comprehensive educational experience, joint academic initiatives, professional development, focusing on curriculum reform and fostering strong innovative and communication skills in students. To participate, a student must maintain a CGPA of **at least 2.5 without any carryover courses** at the time of transition. This

6.17 Release of Academic Results

Senate-approved academic results for each semester shall be released to students through their Academic Department Offices or directly by electronic means to their e-mail addresses on record in the Office of the Registrar, provided they are not indebted to the University.

6.18 Duration of Academic Programme

A student in a four-year degree programme is required to complete the required academic work in eight (8) semesters, but may be allowed to continue for a total of twelve (12) semesters and still qualify for a classified degree provided he/she maintains a CGPA of 1.5 and above.

A student in a five-year degree programme is required to successfully complete their studies in ten (10) to fourteen (14) semesters.

6.19 Graduation Requirements for Bachelor's Degree

All undergraduate students must take and pass all courses specified and offered, including industrial attachment where applicable, by the School/Department and approved by the Senate before graduating from the chosen programme of study. UAST awards its degrees on the authority of the Senate only to students who have been found worthy in character and in learning. That is, apart from successfully completing and passing all prescribed examinations for courses required for a degree programme, students shall not be involved in gross misconduct, such as, but not limited to, unrequited examination misconduct, conviction of felony or other serious criminal offences and association with or membership of secret cult or of any organization proscribed by the University or Government.

6.20 Final Classification of Degrees

The following are classifications of academic degrees awarded by the University:

CGPA	CLASS OF DEGREE
4.50 – 5.00	First Class
3.50 – 4.49	Second Class (Upper Division)
2.40 – 3.49	Second Class (Lower Division)
1.50 – 2.39	Third Class

*** Note: This is subject to any changes in regulations by the NUC.**

SECTION SEVEN

STUDENT GOVERNMENT AND WELFARE

7.0 Student Government Membership

There shall be a Student Representative Council (SRC) on campus whose membership shall be voluntary. Interested students may complete the membership form and pay the designated membership dues to the SRC.

7.1 Structure, Offices and Election of SRC

The SRC shall comprise:

- i) President
- ii) Vice President
- iii) General Secretary
- iv) Deputy General Secretary
- v) Financial Secretary
- vi) Auditor
- vii) Treasurer
- viii) Publicity Secretary;
- ix) School Representatives (2 per School)
- x) Hostel Representatives (2 per Hostel, who are not School Representatives)

7.2 Functions:

- i) Assist Management to foster orderliness and peace on Campus
- ii) Channel students issues or challenges to Management for consideration
- iii) Serve on Committees as Management may assign to them from time to time

7.3 Eligibility for Elections

To be qualified to run for an office in the SRC, a student shall:

- i) Not be in their final year of study.
- ii) Have spent at least one academic session in the University.
- iii) Maintain a CGPA of at least 3.0

7.4 Election Processes and Regulations

Election campaigns, processes, and composition of Election Commission are according to laid down rules and regulations in the SRC Constitution, and voting shall be by secret ballot.

7.5 Students' Centre

There shall be established a Students' Centre on Campus, which shall house offices for the SRC, a shopping complex, and a Common Lounge. However, no part of the Centre shall be converted to residential purpose.

7.6 Student Welfare Board

There shall be a Student Welfare Board, which consists of:

- i) The Vice Chancellor or nominee (Chairman)
- ii) Registrar or representative
- iii) Dean of Student Affairs Unit
- iv) Bursar or representative
- v) Officers of the Halls of Residence
- vi) Chief Security Officer
- vii) Director of Health Services or representative
- viii) Director of Works & Physical Planning
- ix) 2 Senate representatives
- x) 4 Students representatives

7.7 Functions of Student Welfare Board

The Student Welfare Board is responsible for the general welfare of students on campus, and makes recommendations to the Vice-Chancellor through the Chairman regarding enhanced student life on campus. The Board:

- i) Receives and deliberates on complaints from students and the SRC on students' welfare;
- ii) Discusses proposals for enhanced student campus life;
- iii) Supervises all campus services to students, and makes recommendations to the Vice Chancellor on any needed improvements;
- iv) Oversees all preparations for student welfare before commencement of any semester; and
- v) Carries out any assignment from the Vice-Chancellor on student welfare on campus.

7.8 Regularity of Meeting and Quorum

The Student Welfare Board shall meet at least, once a month, and meeting quorum is five (5) members including the Chairman.

SECTION EIGHT

STUDENTS' CONDUCT AND DISCIPLINE ON CAMPUS

8.1 Standard of Personal Discipline

Every student of the University is required to maintain high standard of personal discipline, and shall:

- i) Maintain personal cleanliness and dress in accordance with the dress code of the University. Students are required to be decently dressed at all times on campus. Decent dressing is that which does not expose private body parts; is tidy and clean; does not consist of torn or slit clothes, and which does not present a dishevelled appearance.
- ii) Assist to keep the buildings/walls, grounds, lawns, and general premises of the University clean at all times. Walking on lawns is prohibited; walkways shall be used;
- iii) Avoid posting notices on the walls and unauthorized places; and
- iv) Avoid reckless driving in the premises of the University.

8.2 Freedom of Expression

UAST respects freedom of speech, and requires all its students to be tolerant of opinions and views of others. Accordingly, the University forbids imposition of opinions and beliefs by one student or group of students on others.

8.3 Respect of Jurisdiction

All members of the University community, including students, are subject to the legal jurisdiction of Nigeria. Where the laws of Nigeria take their course, if deemed necessary, interim disciplinary measures against an erring student shall be administered by the University without prejudice to judicial decision by a judge of a law court in Nigeria.

8.4 Non-Smoking and Non-Defacement of University Property

Students shall not smoke in any of the University buildings, including: classrooms, lecture theatres, halls, laboratories, libraries and the University auditoria. Students must avoid writing on University furniture and on walls within and around the University.

8.5 Respect and Courtesy in the University Community

Students shall respect the privacy of other students, as well as show courtesy and respect to staff and guests of the University.

8.6 Pets

Students shall not keep pets on Campus

8.7 Students Organizations

All unregistered organizations (e.g. secret societies/confraternity/sororities) are illegal and are out-rightly banned.

8.7.1 Students Organizations, Clubs, Societies etc.

The policy of the encourages students to organize University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithugh and participate in associations which promote the academic, cultural, recreational and social life of the University. To this extent, the University encourages students' clubs and societies aimed at encouraging a wide variety of disciplinary and professional interests of students. All organizations are required to apply for formal recognition and registration to the Student Affairs Unit for further action. Approval of such application must receive the consent of the Vice-Chancellor.

8.7.2 Conditions for University Recognition

As a policy, the University does not recognize any student organization, which in its membership, discriminates on account of race, sex, or religion. To that extent, tribal and other ethnic student organizations are not encouraged or recognised by the University. Any recognisable student organization, if formed, has to notify the Dean of Students' Affairs of its existence and objectives and to submit the names of their officers and constitution to the University for record purposes, immediately upon appointment.

That is not all; the organization must state its intent to pursue activities which are consistent with the educational and social functions and established policies of the University; an intention of permanence in organization as evidenced by organic constitutions, rules and sources, commensurate with the activities to be undertaken, and the like; and evidence that it is not part of any existing student organization.

Any group of students seeking recognition must submit to the Dean of Student Affairs the following:

- a) Ten (10) copies of the proposed Constitution and By-Laws of the group. Any future amendments must be notified to the Dean of Student Affairs within twenty-four days of the adoption of such amendments, attached to the prescribed forms;
- b) Names, Matriculation Numbers, Hostel and School/Departmental addresses of the officers of the group;
- c) Signature of three Full-Time Senior Academic, Administrative or Technical Staff of the University who have agreed to serve as Adviser/Patron to the organization;
- d) Certified by Adviser/Patron that at least twenty (20) students will form the nucleus of the organization;
- e) Statement of purpose and proposed programmes of activities as it relates to the expected contribution to the academic, cultural, social, or recreational life of the University; and
- f) Affiliation, if any, to outside organizations.

No club, association or society is officially registered unless its members have been interviewed and thoroughly screened. The outcome of the interview will determine the successful clubs to be registered for the session.

8.8 Freedom of Association or Relationship

No student shall be forced into any association or relationship, be it social or personal. Any use of coercion or force is regarded as bullying and highly prohibited.

8.9 Student-Staff Relations

The University of Agriculture, Science and Technology, Ithuthi places high premium on positive student-staff interaction. The relationship between staff and students should be understood as that of joint stakeholders of the University community. Students should feel free to seek the advice and assistance of staff members of the University at all times. Hall Patrons/Matrones and Wardens, the Student Affairs Unit, and School Student Advisers will be particularly happy to assist students at all times.

Further, students should have and know their representatives on the Boards and Committees of the University and they are encouraged to utilize their memberships of these bodies to deepen such relationships.

8.10 Students' Publications

The University has a tradition of a vigorous, free student press, and deliberately encourages responsible freedom of expression and speech in keeping with the best University traditions. Such expressions may be in the form of publications that must bear the name of the University, the names of the organization responsible for the publication and the individual names of the Editorial Board.

The Editorial Board which publishes, sells or distributes printed or otherwise reproduced materials shall be held responsible for such materials including any matters arising such as libel. The Editorial Board must state explicitly on the editorial page that the opinions expressed there are not those of the University or of its student body as a whole. Three copies of all publications emanating from registered students organizations must be deposited in the Student Affairs Unit.

8.10.1 Prohibited Publications

UAST forbids publications that are libellous and/or slanderous; obscene; inciting to violence; literarily substandard and/or not properly signed and titled or are in any way anonymous. Appropriate disciplinary action will be taken against the students who produce such publications.

8.11 Accommodation Arrangement

UAST does not currently apply 100 per cent on-campus residential policy. Accordingly, accommodation in the halls of residence on its campuses is allocated to all registered students each semester of the academic session on the basis of availability at registration. However, accommodation for freshmen (or new students) and seniors (final-year students) is guaranteed if desired by those students.

Students for whom hall accommodation is provided are required to share rooms. Nonetheless, single-occupant apartments/units shall be provided on demand at a premium. They are also required to complete and sign appropriate undertaking. No student is allowed to harbour ‘squatters’ or other illegal lodgers in halls of residence. No cooking utensils will be allowed in the halls of residence. Students allocated spaces in the University halls are required to pay the approved rates for the session along with other school charges. Note that payment of at least 60% of tuition fees is the only guaranteed condition for getting a bed space in the hostel at the beginning of a new academic session.

8.12 Non-Transferable Allocation

The allocation of accommodation is not transferable from one student to another. Any unauthorized person sleeping and using the facilities in halls of residence, if confirmed by the Porter or Warden of the hall concerned, will be punished by being required to pay twice the sessional boarding fees. This will be without prejudice to any other disciplinary action that may be deemed necessary by the University Senate.

8.13 En-suite Facilities

All the rooms of the hostels are fitted with en-suite facilities. Therefore, all students are to meet their ‘conveniences’ needs within their rooms.

8.14 Inspection of Rooms

All rooms shall be inspected once every month. However, any designated official can inspect a student's room at any point as the University authority deems it necessary (but on at least 24-hour notice. Appropriate sanctions apply if damages to facilities or misuse of rooms are identified upon the inspection.

8.15 Repairs, Maintenance and Emergencies

The repairs of the rooms are carried out when they are vacant and particularly during the long vacation. If it is necessary during the semester, when students are still in residence, for repairs to be done, the student will be given a notice of minimum of 24 hours. The University reserves the right to enter the room at all reasonable times to inspect, carry out any necessary works, or to show others round the property (e.g. builders, architects, prospective students and parents, etc.). However, this may not be without the minimal notice as prescribed in this section. Visits will be recorded in a Visitors Book at the Front Desk of the hostel, while notice of visitation may be tucked in the *postal box* by the room or slipped under the door.

Only emergencies which may result in significant risk to life or property may be addressed without the minimum notice required. Students are advised to quickly report emergency cases to the Porters' Lodge or at the hostel Front Desk for prompt action. The staff on duty may wish to speak to the students to ascertain the description and degree of the fault. Repair shall be carried out within the quickest time possible.

8.16 Closing of Hostel Gates

Hostel gates are closed between 12:00 AM and 6:00 AM each day, including Saturdays and Sundays. All students must be in residence before the gates are shut. Any extension of these hours shall be at the discretion of the Hall Patron/Matron from whom permission must be obtained.

8.17 Guest and Visitors

Visiting hours are between 2:00 PM and 4:00 PM on week days and from 12:00 NOON to 5:00 PM on Saturdays, Sundays, and public holidays. Visitors shall not go direct to the students' rooms or to the Common Lounge, but first enquire at the Porters' Lodge/Front Desk, where they must sign the Visitors Book on arrival and on departure at the end of their visit. No visitor is allowed in the students' rooms but only in the Visitors Room or Section of the hostel.

Note: Any student visiting the opposite-gender hostel is regarded as a visitor

It is a punishable conduct for any student to accommodate any visitor in his/her room at any time.

8.18 Security

Students will be issued with a key to their rooms when they sign in at the start of a semester. At the close of each semester, students are required to return to the Porters all keys and other University properties immediately.

As part of the security measures, students are advised to always shut their windows and keep the doors and the wardrobes locked whenever they are not in the rooms. Students are strongly requested to mark all their property and keep a note of such identification marks.

The University will not entertain any complaint of missing property left behind or unsecured by students. Any items left behind or unsecured will be treated as abandoned and may be disposed as waste. Students are encouraged to report any suspicious persons or activities in the hostels immediately to the Porters who will then investigate and take appropriate actions.

8.19 Functions of the Halls Officials

The University has vested the Hall Officials with the power to be notified of students' meetings or activities taking place in the hostels. Such notification must be given through the Porter who may in his/her discretion, allow or disallow any function. Noisy parties involving dancing and drinking are not allowed in the halls of residence.

8.20 Meals

Meals are provided in the Canteens by caterers appointed by the University Management. The canteens will be opened from 6am to 9pm daily including Saturdays and Sundays. Students can, in addition, get their meals elsewhere to eat in their rooms. Under no circumstances should any meal be cooked in students' rooms. In case of illness which must be certified by the officer in charge of the Clinic, meals may be taken to a student in his/her room by private arrangement on approval by the Hostel Officials.

8.21 Television, Radio and Musical instrument

There is a communal Television (TV) facility in the Common Lounges on the ground and last floors. This is reserved for the broadcast of news, key sporting events and relaxation of students.

8.22 Sports Facilities

UAST has a football pitch, tennis courts and other courts. Permission must be obtained from the Director of Sports before use of these facilities. Other indoor games like table tennis, *ayo* or *daa*, snooker, chess, scrabble, etc., will be placed in the Common Lounges of the hostels.

8.23 Fighting, Alcohol and Other Drugs

Fighting is not allowed. Students who engage in fighting shall be asked to withdraw from the hostel and would be sent to the student's Disciplinary Committee for appropriate sanction, including suspension or expulsion from the University. The unlawful possession, use, purchase, or distribution of alcohol on University's property or as part of any University's activity is prohibited.

The unlawful possession, use, purchase, or distribution of illicit drugs, controlled substances (for example, stimulants, depressants, narcotics, or hallucinogenic drugs), or paraphernalia-or the misuse of prescription drugs, including sharing, procuring, buying, or using in a manner different from the prescribed use, or by someone other than the person for whom it was prescribed is prohibited in the University environment.

8.24 Assault, Endangerment, Infliction of Physical Harm, Bullying and Intimidation

At UAST, it is prohibited for any student to engage in physical restraint, assault or any other act of violence or use of physical force against any member of the University community, including himself or herself.

Bullying includes any intentional electronic, written, verbal, or physical act or a series of acts of physical, social, or emotional domination that cause physical or emotional harm to another student or group of students. Bullying conduct may not only cause a negative effect on individuals targeted, but also others who observe the conduct. Bullying conduct is severe, persistent, or pervasive.

Intimidation is any verbal, written, or electronic threats of violence or other threatening behaviour directed toward another person or group that reasonably leads the person(s) in the group to fear for his/her physical well-being. Such act is prohibited, and will result in disciplinary action.

Anyone who attempts to use bullying or intimidation to retaliate against someone who reports an incident, brings a complaint, or participates in an investigation in an attempt to influence the judicial process, will face disciplinary actions. When bullying or act of intimidation occurs in the context of intimate-partner relationship or when the behaviour is perpetrated on the basis of sex or gender, the conduct will be resolved under the Sexual Assault and Harassment Policy/Law of the Government.

The Students Disciplinary Committee will review all such conducts, as well as the circumstances in which they occurred and recommend appropriate sanction, including community service, suspension or expulsion from the University.

8.25 Disorderly Conduct

Disorderly conduct is not permitted. It includes excessive noise, interference with classes, Faculties, Offices, Residence Halls, or other campus and community activities. Wire-less stereo sets and musical Instruments may be played not later than 9:00 PM each day. These instruments should not, however, be played in such a manner as to cause annoyance or disturbance to others. Unauthorized entry into or occupation of a private work area such as construction sites in the University environment; conduct that restricts or prevents members of staff or students from performing their duties, including interruption of meetings, classes, or events; failure to maintain clear passage into or out of any University building or passageway, and/or work space; and failure to disperse when a building, office, or campus space is closed are instances of disorderly conduct.

8.26 Hanging Banners and Pasting Posters

Banners may only be hung in approved designated locations around the hostels and the main administrative or lecture areas. Banners hung elsewhere will be removed. The standard maximum duration for banner display is one (1) week. Also, groups and other associations are limited to one (1) banner reservation per month. Priority is given to student organizations or community-wide events (e.g. student week activities, cultural day celebrations, etc.). Requests for banner space must be made to the Student Affairs Office at least, five (5) working days in advance of the requested starting display date.

All banner designs must be reviewed by the Student Affairs Office prior to installation. Once approved, students must deliver their banners to the Works unit not later than 2:00PM on the Friday before the start of the reservation to ensure their banners are properly hung according to the schedule. Note that the installations of approved banners will not take place on weekends. Banners must not be more than 8-feet long and 5-feet wide; be made of vinyl or durable plastic or colour-fast printed/painted fabric (hemmed); have grommets on the banner corners to ensure secure attachment to the walls; and have a few short slits to stop the wind from catching and ripping the materials. Banners will be taken down by the Works Unit at the expiration of the permitted period or the Monday morning, whichever is earlier. Students are required to retrieve their banners from Works not later than noon, the following day. Failure to do so could result in the disposal of the banner. Free expression guidelines and policies apply to all banner spaces. Harassing, demeaning, uncivil expression, or threats of violence, whether anonymous or signed, are not permitted. External advertisements and solicitations are prohibited.

8.27 Posters

UAST holds that all advertisements, flyers, notices, etc., constitute posters and may only be posted on public bulletin boards. Outdated posters must be promptly removed. The University's recommended posting spots include Common Lounge stalls and residence hall bulletin boards. Masking or painter's tape is approved for use for securing the posters. Use of gum, 'eba' or starch is not allowed. Posters must not be placed on light posts, trash cans, buildings, walls, floors, doors,

windows, walkways, guardrails, stairs, or trees. They must also not be placed on the assigned group bulletin boards in the main administrative building area without permission. Posters need to be “signed” by the leader of a recognized student organization or the individual name of a matriculated owner. No write-ups or images of alcohol are allowed. If posters do not conform to these rules, they will be removed, and the individuals or groups will be fined or held financially responsible for any damages caused.

8.28 Events and Parties

An event in the context of the University’s regulations is defined as an academic, intellectual, cultural, and/or social gathering, which is open to all or a registered group of current students, in a designated campus space. Approval for events can be obtained through the Student Affairs Unit at least two (2) weeks to the date of the event.

A party is defined as a social function regulated by the students Affairs Unit, in a designated campus space and more than ten (10) students are present. Students can organize parties.

A Departmental or School party may be held on-campus and may only be sponsored by UAST staff and/or students. All parties held on-campus are automatically subject to this code. If an individual and/or organization holds a party off-campus depending on whether they informed the Students Affairs Unit or not, it may also be subject to this code. Where the Students Affairs Unit was not informed and infraction occurred, the students will in addition to being subject to this code, be subject to the government policy/law regulating infractions of that nature.

8.29 Fire Safety

At UAST, open flames, including the burning of candles, incense or other unauthorized objects, are not permitted in hostels or any other unauthorized area of the campus. Students must not tamper with or alter in any way the electrical installations in their rooms or in any part of the hostels. The installation and use of cookers, washing machines, toasters, grills, immersion heaters and cooking/boiling rings are not permitted in students’ rooms. In effect, students must not bring into students’ rooms the following gadgets: cookers, washing machines, toasters, grills, immersion heaters, ring boilers/cooking rings, dryers, irons and other heavy electrical gadgets. Students who violate this regulation will be severely dealt with. Students are advised to make arrangements to buy re-chargeable lamps/torchlight only in case there is electricity failure/disruption. In the same vein, tampering, interference, misuse, causing damage, and/or destruction of fire safety and fire prevention equipment are prohibited and are a violation of University law. Any student who causes an alarm to be set off for improper purposes will be liable for the expenses incurred by the fire department(s) in responding to the alarm, in addition to any fines, charges or sanctions that may be applied for violation(s) of this rule. If no individuals accept responsibility when a violation of this rule occurs in a hostel/room, all residents of that hostel/room may be subject to fines and charges for costs incurred by the University and/or fire department(s).

The University will arrange to hold fire drills on a regular basis. Directions for fire drill procedures are posted in every building. Hostel ways and staircases must be kept clear of furniture and any other blockage. Items impinging on free movement in public spaces, including hallways and staircases, will be removed (including cutting locks, when necessary) and their owners will be charged for their removal. Students are financially responsible for damages resulting from reckless conduct or violation of this rule. All incidents of fire will be investigated by the Student Affairs Officer and reported to the Vice Chancellor. Any student in violation of the University's fire safety rules (e.g., unauthorized candle/incense/object burning, tampering with fire safety equipment, etc.) will be subject to restitution and replacement costs, a fine, adjudication through the student conduct process, or other reasonable resolution as deemed by the Student Affairs officials.

8.30 Discrimination and Harassment

At UAST, discrimination is defined as unlawful differential treatment that is based on a sex, race, colour, age, religion, national or ethnic origin, gender identity or expression, pregnancy, marital status, medical condition, veteran status, disability, or any other UAST-recognized protected classification. This type of discrimination can occur in any form and can be directed at individuals or groups. When appropriate, minor infractions can be resolved informally and with remedial steps, including training, counselling, or mediation. When this discrimination objectively and subjectively harms the person or group by severely, persistently, or pervasively interfering with their educational opportunities, peaceful enjoyment of residence and community, or terms of employment, it is subject to disciplinary action, up to and including expulsion/dismissal. In all cases, the University encourages individuals to seek support and assistance as soon as discriminating conduct occurs. Before any conduct can be considered for the student disciplinary process, it must be clear that no substantial free expression interests are threatened by bringing a formal charge of discrimination.

The University also prohibits all forms of harassment, including sexual advances, sexual assault, sexual exploitation, indecent exposure, intimate-partner violence, dating and domestic violence, retaliation, stalking, and other misconduct that is sex or gender based.

If a person has been subjected to harassment in any form, the person should consult with the Counselling & Guidance Unit of the University for Resolution in accordance with the University rules in addition to reporting the misconduct to the Student Affairs Unit.

8.31 Cultism

Cultism in any form in the UAST community is prohibited, whether the activities occur on or off campus. The University supports and will strictly enforce any anti-cultism statute operational in Nigeria. For avoidance of doubt, cultism is the practice of rituals and other activities involving harassment, abuses or humiliation used as a way of initiating a person into a group including a fraternity, sorority, team or club. Cultism recklessly or intentionally endangers the mental or physical health of a student or wilfully destroys or removes public or private property for the

purpose of initiation or admission into or affiliation with, or as a condition for continued membership in any organization.

Cultism includes any brutality of a physical nature, such as whipping, beating, branding, forced calisthenics, exposure to the elements, forced consumption of any food, liquor, drug, or other substance, or other forced physical activity which could adversely affect the physical health and safety of the individual. This involves extreme mental stress, such as sleep deprivation, forced exclusion from social contact, forced conduct which could result in extreme embarrassment, or any other forced activity which could adversely affect the mental health or dignity of the individual, or any wilful destruction or removal of public or private property. The Nigeria's Anti-Cultism Act, 1989 is applicable at UAST in its entirety.

8.32 Smoking

Smoking is prohibited in all spaces throughout the University, including meeting rooms, lounges, offices, and residence hostels.

8.33 Theft and Vandalism

Theft and negligent or intentional damage to personal or University property is prohibited, as is possession of stolen property. Repair and replacement costs will be charged to the appropriate students and may warrant further disciplinary action. In the event that damage occurs in the hostel common space for which no one assumes responsibility, payment for damages will be divided equally among all residents of that hostel. Administrative fees will be added if students do not pay the vandalism costs by the end of the semester. Should damage occur during a student event in a space other than a hall for which no individual student(s) accept(s) responsibility, the sponsoring students and/or organization will be held accountable for the money for replacement or repair of the damaged property and may be subject to further disciplinary action – after the completion of the internal disciplinary process.

8.34 Violation of Local, State, or Federal Law

The violation of the laws, whether Local, State or Federal, by any student may be referred to the Law Enforcement Agencies for appropriate actions.

8.35 Weapons, Fireworks, Animals, Weapons and Other Prohibited Items

Personal belongings which are potentially dangerous to others or which may cause nuisance or anxiety to others are prohibited in the University. Such items include, but not restricted to animals or birds, illegal substances or highly flammable substances (including candles, tea-lights and oil lamps), and weapons or ammunitions of any kind.

8.36 DRESS CODE

8.36.1 General Attire and Decency

At UAST, clothing is regarded as the right of the student; but the students' dress code is aimed at promoting socially acceptable manners. Selecting attire appropriate to specific occasions and activities is a critical factor in the total educational process and luminary leadership development. To this end, students should continually improve the quality of their lives, optimum morale and the overall campus image by how they dress. All this plays a major role in instilling a sense of integrity and an appreciation for values and ethics.

Unless different standards are approved for any week day by Management, the general guides include:

- i) All students must dress in corporate-like attire except when they are in their hostels or actively participating in sporting activities or field practical. Provocatively raunchy sportswear which exposes private parts of the body that are supposed to be concealed (e.g. chest, navel & thighs) is prohibited. Examples include bum shorts, spaghetti straps, transparent clothing.
- ii) While maintaining good taste with high morality and modesty, the appearance of every student should be characterised by neatness, decency and simplicity, which must conform to the unique standards and virtues of UAST.
- iii) Tattooing of any part of the body is highly prohibited. Face caps are not allowed at lectures.

8.36.2 Campus Dress for Female Students

Without limiting the scope of the general standards outlined in 8.36.1, the following regulations apply at all times to all female dressing on campus.

Dressing which is sexually provocative or expose vital parts of the body that are supposed to be concealed (e.g. chest, navel and thigh) is prohibited.

The identity of all students must be visible at all times (i.e. faces must be fully visible). The form of dressing that obscures easy identification or displays immodesty is not allowed. Special examples include the following.

- i) Skirts must be long enough to cover the knees and must not be slit above the knees;
- ii) Transparent, sheer, or tight fitting blouses, sweaters or skirts are not permitted;
- iii) Dresses with low necklines or dresses that do not fully cover the shoulders and armpits are not permitted;
- iv) Shorts, slacks and similar attire should not be worn outside the hostel on campus, except while on field trips;
- v) Trouser suits may be worn but with camisole that are not with low necklines;

- vi) Excessive facial make-up, multi-coloured nail polish, artificial nails and bleaching are not allowed;
- vii) Students are allowed moderate use of unnatural braided hair or attachment, which in any case should not exceed neck-length;
- viii) Unnatural braided hair or attachment should match with the natural hair colour and should be well groomed (neat and tidy) all the time.
- ix) Use of jewellery should be moderate; e.g. dangling and bogus earrings are not allowed;
- x) Noisy and bogus shoes should be avoided.

8.36.3 Campus Dress for Male Students

Without limiting the scope of the general standards outlined in 8.36.1, the following regulations apply at all times to all male dressing on campus.

- i) Men's dresses for lectures and other University occasions should consist of corporate suits (tie - optional) or neat (without holes) trousers and shirts;
- ii) Shorts, slacks and similar attire should not be worn outside the hostel on campus, except while on field trips;
- iii) Men should not go bare-footed or without shirts anywhere on campus and must wear proper sports uniforms when participating in sports activities or outdoor games;
- iv) Noisy and bogus shoes should be avoided;
- v) Men's hair should be kept short, neat and well combed – no unnatural colouring.
- vi) Beards should be clean shaved.

SECTION NINE

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY, EXAMINATION MALPRACTICES, OTHER OFFENCES, AND SANCTIONS

Academic integrity and social safety cannot be guaranteed in any university where examination malpractices and other offences are allowed to go without appropriate sanctions. At UAST, there are rules and regulations that are framed to promote academic integrity and enhance social harmony on campus. This chapter outlines basic instructions to students regarding examinations, various examination malpractices and other conducts that constitute offences, as well as sanctions that are applicable.

9.1 Instructions to Students on University Examination

- i) Only duly matriculated/registered students are eligible to take examinations.
- ii) Students must attend punctually at the times assigned for their papers and they must be in the examination hall at least 30 minutes before the time that each examination is due to start.
- iii) A student is required to deposit his/her bag, briefcase or any other prohibited material at the chief invigilator's desk – or a desk provided for that purpose – before the start of the examination.
- iv) Students shall bring with them to the examinations only their writing materials. Absolutely no book, printed or written document or other communication gadgets or unauthorized aid shall be taken into an examination hall by any student.
- v) Each student shall complete the Attendance Register in triplicate.
- vi) A student shall bring his/her identity card to each examination and display it in a prominent position on his/her desk.
- vii) A student shall write his/her Examination Number, not his/ her name distinctly at the top of the cover of every Answer Booklet and every additional separate sheet of paper.
- viii) During the examination, a student may leave the room temporarily, with the permission of the invigilator only if accompanied by an Attendant. A candidate who leaves the examination hall shall not be readmitted unless throughout the period of absence he/she has been continually under the supervision of an invigilator or an Examination Attendant.
- ix) A student shall not leave the examination hall until the first 30 minutes had elapsed and must be with the special permission of the Chief Invigilator. Such student must drop his/her Question paper and Answer Booklet before leaving.
- x) A student must not give assistance to any other student or permit any other student to copy from or use his/her papers. Similarly, a student must not directly or indirectly accept assistance from any other student or use any other student's papers.

- xi) Any student involved in irregular assistance or cheating during examination shall write a statement on the spot before being allowed to continue with the examination. Refusal of a student to write a statement on the spot shall be regarded as examination misconduct and will be subjected to the University disciplinary action.
- xii) Silence shall be observed in the examination hall. The only permissible way to attract the attention of an invigilator is by a student raising his/her hand.
- xiii) Students are not allowed to smoke, eat or drink in the examination hall.
- xiv) The use of scrap paper is not permitted. All rough work must be done in the Answer Booklets. Even if they contain only rough work, they shall be tied inside the main booklet and crossed out neatly.
- xv) Students are advised in their own interest to write legibly and to avoid using faint ink; answers must be written in English, except as otherwise instructed.
- xvi) On finishing each examination, students should draw a line through any blank space or page of each answer sheet.
- xvii) Before handing in their scripts at the end of the examination, students must satisfy themselves that they have inserted the title of the examination, their matriculation numbers and the numbers of the question they answered, in the appropriate places.
- xviii) At the end of the time allotted, students shall stop writing and stand up when instructed to do so, remain standing and hand in their scripts to the invigilator before leaving the examination hall. Except for the question papers and any allowable material that they brought into the hall with them, students are not allowed to remove or mutilate any paper or materials supplied by the University.

9.2 Examination Malpractices

Examination malpractice within or outside the hall of examination is any act that contravenes examination rules. Undetected, it could potentially fetch the perpetrator undue advantage in performance that is not truly reflective of their genuine academic ability. Indirect actions and/or acts of accomplices that are intended to facilitate this undue advantage are equally condemnable.

9.2.1 Examination Malpractices and Sanctions

Examination malpractices and their applicable sanctions include:

SN	MALPRACTICE	SANCTION
1.	Receiving leaked information relating to an examination paper via any device (electronic, digital, or otherwise) whether written or oral from any person(s) or during the examination	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course, and suspended from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters

2.	Verbal or physical assault and intimidation of the Invigilator(s)/ Examiner(s) during or after the examination	Suspended from the University for four (4) consecutive semesters
3.	Submitting false documentation in order to sit for an examination for which a student is not qualified (e.g. the student did not register for the course for which the examination is conducted)	Suspended from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters
4.	Smuggling of cheat notes or aids into the examination hall or its environs	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course, and suspended from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters
5.	Unauthorized oral and/or written communication between students during the examination	Disqualified from the examination, and an F grade for the course
6.	Copying from another student's answer sheet/booklet, or exchanging question papers and or/answer sheets during examination	Disqualified from the examination, and an F grade for the course
7.	Collaborating with invigilators, lecturers, or any other person during examination to access answers to examination question(s)	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course and suspended from the University for one (1) semester
8.	Having credible evidence that the questions for a scheduled examination have been leaked before the examination is taken, but failing, neglecting, or refusing to report to appropriate authorities (e.g. Department Chair, Dean, Vice-Chancellor)	Disqualified from the examination, F grade for the course, and suspended from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters
9.	Unauthorized removal of answer scripts/booklets from the examination hall and/or non-submission of answer scripts/booklets at the end of the examination	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course and suspended from the University for one (1) semester
10.	Collusion or collaboration with a member of staff or using any means to submit a newly prepared answer sheet/booklet for the original script after an examination	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course, and suspended from the University for four (4) consecutive semesters
11.	Collusion or collaboration with a member of staff to modify examination scores on answer script and/or other mark sheets (digital or otherwise)	Disqualified from the examination, with F grade for the course, and suspended from the University for four (4) consecutive semesters

12.	Attempting to destroy and/or destroying evidence of examination malpractice	Expelled from the University
13.	A student who allegedly commits any of the examination offences listed under Section 9 of this Handbook and refuses, neglects, or fails to complete all relevant portions of the Examination Infraction Form, shall be expelled from the University	Expelled from the University
14.	Refusal to cooperate with an investigation Panel or Committee in the investigation of some alleged examination malpractice (s)	Expelled from the University

9.2.2 Procedures for Sanctions for Examination Malpractice

Step 1: The Examination Invigilator, who personally catches a student committing the infraction, shall alert a Security Officer assigned to the premises of the examination, administer the Examination Infraction Form to the student who allegedly committed the offence, who shall fully complete every relevant portion and append his/her signature;

Step 2: The Invigilator shall check and describe the type of malpractice committed, and sign off on the Form (additional pages of statement could be attached);

Step 3: The Security Officer mentioned in Step 1 shall also make a statement on the Form and sign (If there are other staff members who witnessed the infraction, they shall sign their names and signatures on the form, make and attach any relevant statements);

Step 4: Outside examination hall, the University staff or student who uncovers the offence shall make a formal report to the Chief Security officer of the University;

Step 5: The Chief Security Officer (CSO) shall invite the student concerned and give him/her an Examination Infraction Form to complete; the reporting staff or student and any witnesses shall also complete the same Form, and make statements on the alleged offence;

Step 6: The Invigilator or, if outside examination hall, CSO shall make three (3) copies each of the Examination Infraction Form mentioned in the Steps above;

Step 7: The original copies of the Examination Infraction Form and statements mentioned in Steps 1 to 5 shall be submitted to the Vice-Chancellor directly by the Invigilator or CSO, who will give the Head of Department and Dean of the School of the student a set each of their photocopies.

Step 8: Within one week of receiving the documents mentioned in Step 7, the Vice-Chancellor shall submit them to the Chairman of the Senate Students' Disciplinary Committee. The

Committee shall conduct hearings and investigations, and report its findings (including recommendations) to the University Senate through the Vice-Chancellor not later than **three weeks** after the semester's final examinations. The hearings are time-barred.

Step 9: The decision of the Senate is final, and shall be communicated to the student in writing by the University Registrar.

9.3 Other Offences and Applicable Sanctions

SN	OFFENCE	SANCTION
1.	Causing noise or nuisance in the hostel by excessively raising the volume of electronic gadgets, or loudly playing musical instruments at unauthorized times and locations	Verbal warning is given for first offence; written warning is given for second offence; and for third offence, the student is expelled from the hostel without refund of fees
2.	Smoking in the student hostel	Verbal warning is given for first offence; written warning is given for second offence; and for third offence, the student is expelled from the hostel without refund of fees
3.	Accommodating unauthorized visitors in the hostel	Expulsion from the hostel without refund of fees
4.	Subletting of assigned hostel room or bed space	Expulsion from the hostel without refund of fees
5.	Violation of any regulations guiding religious observance in student hostel	Expulsion from the hostel without refund of fees
6.	Littering of University halls, rooms, and premises, and walking on lawns	One-week community service for first offence. For second and subsequent offences, one-week community service and a fine of Twenty-Five Thousand Naira (₦25,000.00) or as reviewed from time-to-time by the University Senate
7.	Drunkenness, alcohol and drug or substance abuse, or possession of hard drugs and all such substances banned by the Federal Government of Nigeria or the Benue State Government	Suspension for one (1) semester, and evidence of rehabilitation before re-admission to the University
8.	Unlawful assembly or loitering around prohibited areas, and refusal to disband when asked to do so by University Security	A written warning and one-week community service
9.	Fighting or inciting others to fight	Suspension from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters and an undertaking

		to be of good conduct before re-admission to the University
10.	Molestation of staff and fellow students (bullying, harassment, assault etc.)	Suspension from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters and an undertaking to be of good conduct before re-admission to the University
11.	Disruption of assemblies approved by the University	Suspension from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters and an undertaking to be of good conduct before re-admission to the University
12.	Promoting or causing arson, wilful destruction or damage of University property	Suspension for one (1) semester, payment of adequate compensation imposed by the University Senate, and submission of an undertaking by a parent or guardian that the student shall be of good behaviour before re-admission to the University
13.	Stealing, pilfering, or appropriating without permission belongings of other persons	Suspension for one (1) semester, and evidence of rehabilitation before re-admission to the University
14.	Forgery, alteration, misuse or mutilation of documents, records, identity cards, etc.	If the forgery involves academic documents, the student shall be expelled from the University, while the forgery of any other University document attract a suspension of one (1) semester
15.	Impersonation of a student at lectures, examinations, or any other University activity	Suspension from the University for four (4) consecutive semesters
16.	Plagiarism	Suspension from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters
17.	Writing projects, laboratory, or other field reports for a student	Suspension from the University for two (2) consecutive semesters
18.	Obscene and libellous publications online or in print	A written warning and one-week community service
19.	Rioting or any behaviour capable of causing breach of the peace	Suspension for three (3) weeks, payment of compensation prescribed by the Senate for any damages, and submission of an undertaking by a parent or guardian that the student shall be of good behaviour before re-admission to the University

20.	Membership of secret cults and such other anti-social organizations, or coercing others to join secret cults	Expulsion from the University
21.	All other acts which, under the laws of Nigeria, are considered illegal	The University shall hand over the student to lawful authorities in Nigeria; and while the matter is under investigation or adjudication, the student shall remain under indefinite suspension from all activities of the University
22.	Violation of the University dress code	The student shall be reprimanded and restricted from lecture rooms, libraries, laboratories, cafeteria, sports facilities, clinic, offices, examination halls, and any other public facilities of the University. Repeat offending may lead to the dress or dresses being confiscated or destroyed, and ultimately one (1) semester suspension

9.4 Effect of suspension or expulsion

A student who has been suspended or expelled shall not enter the University's premises. And, whatever sanctions imposed by the University do not preclude any additional requisite prosecution and compensations required under the Nigerian legal system.

9.5 Procedures for Sanctions for Sundry Offences

The following steps shall be taken before any sanction is imposed on an offending student:

Step 1: An official written report is made of the incident by the complainant to both the Chief Security Officer and Dean of Student Affairs of the University.

Step 2: The Chief Security Officer and Dean of Student Affairs shall collaborate to investigate the matter speedily, provided that this shall not exceed two (2) weeks from the date of receipt of the complaint.

Step 3: If culpability is established, the Chief Security Officer shall make a formal report of the matter to the Registrar who shall within one (1) week of receiving the report submit same to the Chairman of the Senate Student Disciplinary Committee.

Step 4: The Senate Student Disciplinary Committee shall conduct hearings and relevant investigations, and submit a written report (with recommendations) to the University Senate through the Vice-Chancellor not later than three weeks after commencement of hearing.

Step 5: The decision of Senate is final, and shall be communicated in writing to the student through the Registrar of the University.

9.6 Vice Chancellor's Power to Discipline

Nothing in Section 9 shall preclude the Vice-Chancellor from exercising the powers regarding discipline of students as stipulated in the University Law and in a manner that is expedient for the good order, peace and progress of the University.

9.7 Definition and Application of Sanctions

The sanctions that may be imposed for violation of University Regulations or Code of Conduct include but not limited to:

- i) **Fines:** These are monetary sanctions that must be paid within specified periods to avoid further stringent actions being imposed.
- ii) **Disciplinary Probations:** Disciplinary probation is a trial period of time during which a student must behave in a manner acceptable to the University. The Students Disciplinary Committee may impose terms which will restrict the student's participation in extra-curricular and/or other activities.
- iii) **Loss of privilege:** This is the withdrawal of a privilege or use of a service or facility (such as Library or Sports) for a specified period of time.
- iv) **Reimbursement:** Reimbursement requires that a student must pay for damage to, loss or misappropriation of University property or the property of other members of the University community. Such reimbursement is charged on any student who, acting alone or through group concerted activities, organises or knowingly participates in the events which cause damage or loss.
- v) **Suspension:** Suspension is an action which excludes the students from registration, class attendance, residence in an official University Hall, or the use of University facilities for a specified period of time. This action means that the student must immediately leave the campus.
- vi) **Expulsion:** Expulsion is the permanent withdrawal of students' privileges of registration, class attendance or residence in an official University Hall by the authority of the Vice-Chancellor. The privileges of the use of University facilities are also withdrawn by this sanction. This action means that the student must leave the campus immediately, and cease henceforth to be a member of the University community.

9.8 Appeal

In disciplinary cases, students concerned have a right of appeal through the Vice-Chancellor to the Council against the decision of the Students Disciplinary Committee or any other person.